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Fields of Concentration:
Primary: Labor Economics, Public Economics
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Qualifying Examinations Completed:
2023 (Oral): Labor Economics, Public Economics

Dissertation Title: *Empirical Evaluations of Child Care Policy*

Committee:
Professor Joseph Altonji (Chair)
Professor John Eric Humphries
Professor Costas Meghir
Professor Christopher Neilson

Education:
Ph.D., Economics, Yale University, 2027 (expected)
M.Phil., Economics, Yale University, 2024
M.A., Economics, Yale University, 2024
B.A., Economics (with honors), Mathematics, and Applied Mathematics and Statistics (with honors), Johns Hopkins University, 2021

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:
Washington Center for Equitable Growth Fellowship ($15,000), 2025
Doctoral Fellowship, Yale University, 2021-2026
Cowles Foundation Fellowship, Yale University, 2021-2026
Max Hochschild Award (for achievement in economics), Johns Hopkins University, 2021
Applied Mathematics and Statistics Academic Achievement Award, Johns Hopkins University, 2021
Woodrow Wilson Undergraduate Research Fellowship ($10,000), Johns Hopkins University, 2017-2021

Research Grants:
Cowles Foundation Grants, 2023-2025 ($43,500), with Ryan Haygood and Pamela Torola

Teaching Experience:

Spring 2024, 2025, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Benjamin Polak and Prof. Jidong Zhou, Games and Information (U, G), Yale College and School of Management (Head TA in 2025)
Fall 2023, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Steven Berry, Introductory Microeconomics (U), Yale College
Spring 2020, 2021, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Beryl Castello, Mathematical Game Theory (U, G), Johns Hopkins Krieger School of Arts and Sciences (Head TA in 2021)
Fall 2020, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Muhammad Husain, Econometrics (U), Johns Hopkins Krieger School of Arts and Sciences
Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Peer-led Team Learning Leader (Tutor), Linear Algebra and Microeconomics (U), Johns Hopkins Krieger School of Arts and Sciences
Fall 2019-Spring 2021, Learning Den Tutor, Microeconomics, Calculus, and Statistics (U), Johns Hopkins Krieger School of Arts and Sciences

Research Experience:

Research Assistant to Costas Meghir, Yale University, 2024
Research Assistant to Joseph Altonji, Yale University, 2022

Publications:

"The Effect of Child Care on Female Labor Supply and Child Development in Low- and Middle-Income Countries" (forthcoming, 2027) with Costas Meghir, accepted at *Annual Review of Economics*, Volume 19.

Working Papers:

"Generosity vs. Access: The Effects of Subsidy Policy on Price and Quality of Child Care," (November 2026), *Job Market Paper*

Work In Progress:

"Family Structure, Family Income, and Race" with Joseph Altonji, (2026)
"For-Profit Colleges and the Sources of Undermatching" with Ryan Haygood and Pamela Torola, (2026)
"Public Preschool, Child Development, and Maternal Labor Outcomes: Experimental Evidence from Kenya" with Costas Meghir and Helen Baker-Henningham, (2026)
"Maternal Employment and Access to Quality Child Care" (2026)

Seminar and Conference Presentations:

ASSA Annual Meetings: 2027 (forthcoming)

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References:

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Dissertation Abstract

Generosity vs. Access: The Effects of Subsidy Policy on Price and Quality of Child Care [Job Market Paper]

Quality child care can improve low-income children's outcomes. The Child Care and Development Fund, the largest child care program in the United States, gives states $12.4 billion annually to spend on child care subsidies. Given a fixed budget, states trade off serving more families against giving larger subsidies to fewer families. Which choice enrolls more low-income families in quality care is unclear: both the maximum subsidy and the number of families subsidized shift demand, and prices and quality respond in equilibrium. In this paper, I study the effects of Wisconsin's 2022 reform, which increased the average maximum subsidy per family by 130%. I compare this reform against spending the same budget on serving more families by using quasi-experimental variation and a structural model with endogenous prices, quality, and the number of subsidized families. Under the larger subsidy, consumer welfare for eligible families is 17% lower and producer surplus is 2% lower relative to serving more families.

Using novel administrative data, I first show that providers change their price and quality in response to the maximum subsidy and the share of nearby families receiving subsidies. In this setting, the maximum subsidy and the number of families subsidized in a neighborhood are both endogenous. I use two sources of variation to disentangle the effect of each. The first is geographic variation in the fixed costs of applying for subsidies. The second is variation in the maximum subsidy over time, by county, and by whether the provider operates in commercial or residential facilities. I find that a higher maximum subsidy leads to higher out-of-pocket payments. Reducing the share of families receiving subsidies reduces the likelihood a neighborhood has access to higher-quality care. These results show that private provider responses must be accounted for when estimating the effect of changes in the maximum subsidy under a fixed budget. It is still unclear, however, how many fewer families would be subsidized if the state adopted a larger maximum subsidy under a fixed budget. The answer depends on simultaneous changes in family choices, prices, and quality. Further, these results cannot say whether price and quality changes affect enrollment more than changes in family choices.

Motivated by these findings, I develop an equilibrium model of the child care market. Providers first invest in quality, anticipating competition and demand. After observing their quality and the quality of nearby providers, providers choose prices to maximize profit. Families then choose from nearby private and public providers or choose to forgo formal care. Subsidized families pay less out of pocket for private care, up to the maximum. Because subsidized families cannot pay less than zero, the subsidy compresses out-of-pocket payment differences across providers, increasing demand for non-price characteristics like quality. The state's budget limits how many families receive the subsidy: as the maximum subsidy increases, fewer families are subsidized.

I estimate demand and marginal cost parameters to match enrollment and other moments from the data. Prices and enrollment are endogenous, so I instrument with nearby provider characteristics, the fixed costs of applying for subsidies, and time-varying exposure to spillovers from wage subsidies. I estimate quality choice parameters to match the quality distribution. I find that 17% more low-income children enroll in either public care or high-quality private care relative to subsidizing more families, in large part because unsubsidized families substitute with public care. However, 19% more low-income children do not enroll in formal care overall. Higher prices explain 61% of this difference. Additionally, 11% more low-income children enroll in low-quality private care, as the quality of local care falls and fewer children receive subsidies.

The Effect of Child Care on Female Labor Supply and Child Development in Low- and Middle-Income Countries with Costas Meghir

Child care services can offer an opportunity for women to develop their careers and increase household income. At the same time, it can affect the development of children, depending on the quality of care. We first develop a collective model of the household as a conceptual framework to show how improving the availability of child care can affect mothers' labor market opportunities and earnings and how it can affect child development. We then review the literature on the effects of child care on the employment and earnings of women and on child development. Child care can increase mothers' employment. However, limited work opportunities or strict norms against maternal work can keep mothers out of the labor force. When other family members provide care, child care can free these caregivers to work or attend school. When studies measure the impact on child development, the results are mixed and depend on both context and quality of provision.

Maternal Employment and Access to Quality Child Care

I study family labor supply decisions when child care is a cost of work: not only in terms of the price of care, but also distance traveled and children's developmental losses if families settle for lower-quality care. First, I develop a theoretical framework where families choose which parents will work, conditional on the cost of formal care, to maximize household utility. Families weigh consumption, their time, and their children's human capital. Families who live further from high-quality care must either travel further for high-quality care, costing them their time, or use low-quality care, which is less effective at producing children's human capital. Second, I leverage a quasi-exogenous shock to the price and quality of child care. Oregon sets the maximum child care subsidy for large, discontiguous regions to the 75th percentile of prices. Neighborhoods are exposed to a higher maximum subsidy relative to local prices if a faraway neighborhood experiences a cost shock, say because of a population change. Using novel administrative data, I show the effect on local price and quality when the maximum subsidy rises exogenously. I then evaluate the resulting effects on

maternal employment, focusing on mothers who are married or have a college degree, and so are unlikely to receive subsidies.